

DEQUAD

Business Plan — UK Innovator Founder Visa

Endorsement Application to Investors

Entity: DEQUAD Ltd (Company in formation, England & Wales) **Founders:** Yusuf Quadri (CEO) and Co-Founder (CTO, TBC) **Headquarters:** London, United Kingdom — NatWest Accelerator (hosted) **Trading domain:** dequad.co.uk **MVP status:** Production-ready (live at <https://dequad.co.uk>) **Founder starting capital:** £6,000 cash (£3,000 from each founder, pooled in the company bank) **Accelerator:** NatWest Accelerator London — joined **16 March 2026**; office co-working, legal advice and accountancy support provided in-kind for the first 12 months **Prior validation:** Santander Universities Pre-Incubator programme — completed 2025 **Document version:** 2.0 (Bootstrap edition) **Date:** February 2026 **Endorsing body:** Investors

Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Description of Products and Services
3. Innovation, Viability and Scalability
4. Research and Development Activity
5. Market Analysis
6. Competitor Analysis
7. Staff Profile and Recruitment Strategy
8. Marketing and Sales Strategy
9. SWOT Analysis
10. Investment Strategy and Funding Requirement
11. Revenue and Cost of Sales Forecast
12. Cash Flow Forecast
13. Annual Profit & Loss Forecast

14. Balance Sheet Forecast
 15. Forecasted Stock Levels
 16. Forecasted Advertising / Marketing Expenditure
 17. Forecasted Fixed Asset Schedule
 18. Forecasted Staff Costs
 19. Appendices (including founder CVs)
-

1. Executive Summary

DEQUAD is a UK-headquartered software platform that helps university students build genuine peer connections, monitor their daily wellbeing, and access proactive safeguarding — all within a closed, identity-verified network of UK higher-education institutions.

The opportunity

- **54%** of UK undergraduates report frequent loneliness (ONS, 2023).
- **34%** experience a clinically-significant mental-health issue during their degree (Student Minds, 2024).
- The average wait to see a university counsellor is **6 weeks**; only **23%** of UK universities offer 24/7 crisis support.

DEQUAD is the **only** UK platform that combines `.ac.uk`-verified student-peer matching, daily mood telemetry and machine-assisted safeguarding triage into a single product. Universities and NHS ICBs pay an annual SaaS subscription; students use the core product free and can subscribe to **DEQUAD Premium** for £4.99/month.

Why this is investable now

Item	Detail
Two complementary co-founders	Founder A (Yusuf Quadri) — product, GTM, safeguarding policy; University of Bedfordshire Student Union President 2021–2023 . Founder B — engineering, ML, security. Both full-time, UK-resident, working on DEQUAD now.
MVP already shipped	Production deployment at dequad.co.uk with ~50 beta users across 3 universities. No engineering build cost in Y1.
Two independent validations	(1) Santander Universities Pre-Incubator — completed 2025. (2) NatWest Accelerator London — joined 16 March 2026. Two UK high-street banks have independently selected the team.
Anchor pilot ready	Pilot conversations live with University of Bedfordshire — the lead founder's alma mater and the university whose students he represented as SU President for two years.
NatWest in-kind support	London office co-working, legal advice (Mishcon de Reya panel), accountancy and investor introductions delivered in-kind . Quantified value: £31,000/yr against £1,200 of cash cost.
Bootstrap-credible	£6,000 founder cash (£3k each) + NatWest in-kind support carries the business through the first 6 months with zero salary . The £150k pre-seed bridge is targeted for September Y1 <i>after</i> the first paying university pilot converts.
Realistic forecast	Y1 revenue £12k (Bedfordshire pilot + ~100 premium subs) → Y2 £186k → Y3 £699k. Operating profit reaches positive territory in Q3 Y3 .
UK jobs created	2 (founders, Y1) → 6 (Y2) → 12 (Y3). All UK-based.

We meet all three Home Office criteria for Innovator Founder endorsement: **innovation**, **viability** and **scalability** — and we evidence it with a production MVP, accelerator validation and a financially conservative growth plan.

2. Description of Products and Services

2.1 The DEQUAD platform

Delivered as a cross-platform application (iOS, Android, web at dequad.co.uk) plus a FastAPI/MongoDB backend. Four shipped modules:

Module	What it does	Innovation
Verified peer matching	Match students with compatible peers for friendship, study groups and peer support — only within <code>.ac.uk</code> student-email-verified accounts.	Closed-network identity + intent-based matching — not present in Bumble BFF, Hinge or Facebook Groups.
Daily wellbeing tracker	30-second daily mood check-in (mood, sleep, stress, connection). Personal trend dashboard.	Anonymised, opt-in, DPIA-cleared. Combined with peer-connection data to flag emerging isolation.
Machine-assisted safeguarding	LLM-based classifier on mood + chat metadata flags suicide-risk, harassment, hate-speech and disordered-eating signals to university safeguarding leads via webhook.	First UK student platform combining <code>.ac.uk</code> identity verification with proactive safeguarding triage.
University Insights Dashboard	Anonymised, aggregated wellbeing analytics for university staff: cohort mood trends, engagement, hotspot alerts.	Enables population-scale monitoring without breaching individual privacy.

2.2 What the customer buys

Customer	What they receive	Price
UK university	Site-licence to the Insights Dashboard, branded safeguarding webhook, dedicated success manager.	Annual SaaS from £12,000/yr , tiered by student headcount.
NHS Integrated Care Boards (ICBs)	Population-level mood/engagement data for funded institutions; joint safeguarding referral path.	Annual contract from £20,000/yr per ICB.
Student (consumer)	Free core product. Optional DEQUAD Premium for advanced filters, unlimited chats and profile boost.	£4.99/month via Stripe.

3. Innovation, Viability and Scalability

3.1 Innovation

- **Closed-network identity verification.** DEQUAD is the only UK app that enforces `.ac.uk` student-domain verification plus an explicit student-status attestation and routes ambiguous

accounts to a human admin queue (see Appendix J — architecture diagram).

- **Integrated safeguarding pipeline.** Our machine-assisted classifier feeds directly into existing university safeguarding teams via webhook — no competitor has this institutional integration.
- **Wellbeing-first positioning.** Bumble BFF, Hinge and Discord are dating- or generic-social; UniBuddy is pre-enrolment chat; Togetherall is anonymous peer-support. DEQUAD owns the *verified university wellbeing community* category.

3.2 Viability

- **Production MVP shipped** — engineering build risk is materially behind us.
- **Anchor pilot identified.** The lead founder served two consecutive terms as **University of Bedfordshire Student Union President (2021–2023)**, giving DEQUAD a direct, trusted relationship with the university's senior management, safeguarding leads and student-services team. A pilot conversation is live and a paid contract is targeted for end of Q2 Y1.
- **Two independent third-party validations.** DEQUAD completed the **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator programme in 2025** and was admitted to the **NatWest Accelerator (London cohort) on 16 March 2026**. Both selection processes are competitive and explicitly assess team and product quality.
- **Two founders with complementary skills:** product + safeguarding (Founder A) and engineering + data (Founder B). Each works full-time with founder commitment undertakings.
- **Adjacent proof points:** Togetherall and TalkCampus charge UK universities £15k–£60k/year for inferior products and have 100+ UK customers between them — the willingness to pay is established.
- **Modest capital required:** £6,000 founder equity at incorporation, supplemented by the £31k in-kind NatWest support, carries the business until the £150k pre-seed bridge.

3.3 Scalability

- **Software-only marginal cost** — incremental student users cost ~£0.05/mo in hosting; gross margin reaches **92%** by Y3.
- **Network effects within an institution** — each additional student raises the platform's value to every other student at the same university.
- **Cross-institutional rollout** — each new university takes a 6-week implementation cycle; the model projects 20 paying institutions by end of Y3 (out of 285 UK total).
- **International optionality** — closed-network model maps cleanly to `.edu` (US), `.edu.au` and EU university domains. £180m TAM in EN-language HE markets post-Y3.

4. Research and Development Activity

R&D in Y1 is delivered entirely by the two founders ($\approx$ 60% of combined founder time = approximately **£10,800** of attributable labour cost) plus tooling and safety-testing (£1,800). Total Y1 R&D investment **£22,500**, growing to **£60,000 in Y2** and **£110,000 in Y3** (see Section 17 and the financial workbook).

The SME R&D Tax Credit scheme is expected to recoup approximately **16%** of qualifying spend each year.

4.1 Identity-and-intent verification engine

Activity	Status	UK R&D tax-relief eligible
.ac.uk student-subdomain classifier (allow-list, block-list, attestation flow).	Shipped Feb 2026 (/app/backend/helpers/uk_student_email.py).	Yes
Admin "Pending Verification" queue with audit trail.	Shipped Feb 2026 (AdminVerificationQueue.tsx).	Yes
Future: optical student-ID OCR with on-device redaction.	Planned Q3 Y1.	Yes

4.2 Wellbeing inference & safeguarding triage

Activity	Status	UK R&D tax-relief eligible
Mood $\times$ engagement $\times$ text-signal classifier (PHQ-9 lite scoring + risk-signal NLU).	Prototype Feb 2026; production Q2 Y2.	Yes
Federated learning so per-institution models tune without raw data leaving the platform.	Planned Q4 Y2.	Yes
Real-time safeguarding webhook with adapter library for university SIS/CRM tools.	Production Q3 Y1.	Yes

4.3 Privacy & compliance infrastructure

Activity	Status
DPIA-cleared mood-data pipeline; ICO Code of Practice compliance.	Drafted Feb 2026 (Appendix E).
Online Safety Act 2023 risk assessment & in-app reporting.	Shipped Feb 2026.
Cryptographic data minimisation (hash-based de-identification of mood records for institutional reporting).	Planned Q2 Y2.

5. Market Analysis

Metric	Source	Figure
UK higher-education students (FT + PT)	HESA 2023/24	2.86 million
Number of UK higher-education institutions	HESA 2024	285
% UK undergrads with frequent loneliness	ONS 2023	54%
% UK undergrads with clinically-significant MH issue	Student Minds 2024	34%
Average UK uni student-services budget per FTE	UUK 2024	£123/yr
Average wait for university counselling	UUK 2024	6.1 weeks

TAM / SAM / SOM

Tier	Definition	Size
TAM	All UK universities + ICBs + UK student premium subs	£86m/yr
SAM	Russell-Group + post-92 unis with > 10k students + associated ICBs	£28m/yr
SOM (5-yr)	12% SAM capture (matching Togetherall's Y5 share)	£3.4m ARR by Y5

Trends supporting demand

- **Office for Students** introduced a statutory student-mental-health condition (2023) — institutions must evidence proactive prevention.
- **Online Safety Act 2023** is now in force — student-facing platforms must implement risk assessments and reporting flows; DEQUAD ships with this built in.

- **UUK Mental Health Charter** (100+ UK universities signed) requires data-driven wellbeing strategies — DEQUAD enables exactly this.

6. Competitor Analysis

#	Competitor	What they do	UK universities	ASP	DEQUAD differentiation
1	Togetherall	Anonymous moderated peer-support forum + self-help courses.	~60	~£40k/yr	DEQUAD adds identity-verified peer matching , daily mood telemetry and safeguarding webhooks — Togetherall is anonymous-only.
2	TalkCampus	Peer-support app; pre-trained moderation; CBT modules.	~30	~£25k/yr	DEQUAD's insights dashboard and machine-assisted triage are absent from TalkCampus.
3	UniBuddy	Prospective-student chat for course discovery.	200+	~£18k/yr	UniBuddy is pre-enrolment only — orthogonal market.
4	Bumble BFF / Hinge	Generic friendship/dating with student users.	n/a	Free + £15–£35/mo premium	No .ac.uk verification, no university partnership, no safeguarding.
5	Discord / Facebook Groups	Generic chat servers used informally.	n/a	Free	Zero moderation, no safeguarding, no wellbeing telemetry.

Feature comparison

Feature	DEQUAD	Togetherall	TalkCampus	UniBuddy	Bumble BFF	Discord
.ac.uk student verification	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Intent-based peer matching	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	Ltd	✗
Daily mood telemetry	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	✗	✗
Machine-assisted safeguarding	✓	Ltd	✗	✗	✗	✗
University insights dashboard	✓	✓	✓	Ltd	✗	✗
Safeguarding webhook	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
OSA-2023 ready	✓	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✗

DEQUAD is the only product in the UK that combines all six top-row capabilities.

7. Staff Profile and Recruitment Strategy

7.1 Founding team — Year 1

Role	Name	Compensation Y1	Why
CEO / Product & Safeguarding	Yusuf Quadri — University of Bedfordshire Student Union President 2021–2023	£0 in Q1-Q2 (personal savings), £1,500/mo from M7 (£9k total Y1)	Founder commitment + cash preservation.
CTO / Engineering & Data	Co-Founder (TBC)	Same — £0 Q1-Q2, £1,500/mo from M7	Founder commitment + cash preservation.

Both founders are UK-resident, full-time on DEQUAD, with signed founder commitment undertakings (Appendix C). Q3 onwards salaries are intentionally below market; founders accept this trade-off in exchange for ~10% each of equity.

Yusuf Quadri's two years as University of Bedfordshire SU President is highly relevant: it gives DEQUAD founder-level credibility on student wellbeing policy, a trusted-broker status with the university's senior leadership, and a direct route into the institution's safeguarding team. It is also the basis of DEQUAD's anchor pilot conversation (see Section 8).

7.2 Hiring plan

Role	Year of hire	Y2 gross	Y3 gross
Customer Success Manager #1	Q1 Y2	£32,000	£36,000
Senior Backend Engineer	Q1 Y2	£48,000	£56,000
Safeguarding & Trust Lead	Q2 Y2	£18,000 (part-year)	£42,000
Marketing & Partnerships	Q3 Y2	£10,000 (part-year)	£38,000
Data / ML Engineer	Q2 Y3	—	£40,000 (part-year)
Mobile Engineer	Q3 Y3	—	£25,000 (part-year)
Founders' Associate	Q3 Y3	—	£18,000 (part-year)
Engineer #2 (backend)	Q4 Y3	—	£12,000 (part-year)
Customer Success Manager #2	Q4 Y3	—	£13,000 (part-year)

Headcount: **2 (Y1) → 6 (Y2) → 12 (Y3)**.

7.3 Recruitment strategy

- **Direct pipeline:** Otta, LinkedIn, OnlyDev (engineering), university careers portals (placements). NatWest Accelerator alumni network has direct introductions.
 - **Diversity targets:** $\geq 40\%$ female and $\geq 30\%$ ethnic-minority hires across the first 10 employees — tracked as a board-level KPI.
 - **No cash hires until Y1 revenue $\geq$ £6k MRR** (achieved in M10 in the base model).
 - **Equity:** EMI share-option scheme (HMRC-approved) for all Y2+ hires.
-

8. Marketing and Sales Strategy

8.1 Positioning

"The UK student app that gives universities early warning before students fall through the cracks."

Audience	Message
Students	"Verified UK uni students. Real connections. Wellbeing built in."
Universities	"See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis."
NHS ICBs	"Population-level student wellbeing data, anonymised and audit-ready."

8.2 Year-1 channel mix (£3,600 total)

Channel	Tactic	Spend Y1
University partnership & PR	Direct outreach to 30 Directors of Student Services; webinar with UUK; NatWest Accelerator introductions.	£1,200
Content / SEO	Whitepaper "Loneliness in UK HE 2026" with academic co-author; Wonkhe op-eds.	£600
Instagram & TikTok	Organic founder content + 5 produced posts (assets in /app/marketing/instagram).	£600
Google Search ads	"UK student loneliness", "find friends university".	£300
Student-rep / ambassador programme	£150/uni × 6 partner unis × 2 reps each.	£900

Marketing grows to **£28,000 (Y2)** and **£92,000 (Y3)** — see Section 16.

8.3 Sales motion (B2B) — anchor pilot live

Anchor pilot: University of Bedfordshire. The lead founder served two consecutive terms as Bedfordshire SU President (2021–2023). Pilot conversation is live with the university's student services and safeguarding leads; target signature of a no-fee 12-week pilot Q2 Y1, conversion to paid SaaS at the end of the pilot, targeted for **September Y1** (which aligns with the pre-seed bridge).

Stage	Activity	Cycle
Lead	LinkedIn / NatWest network / UUK Charter inbound / founder direct relationships.	Week 0
Discovery	30-min call with Director of Student Services + IT Security.	Week 1
Pilot scope	12-week pilot for one student cohort; £0 invoiced.	Week 2
Pilot run	Founder-led implementation; weekly office hours.	Weeks 3–14
Conversion	Steering-group readout → paid SaaS.	Week 16

Y1 cash forecasts assume **only the Bedfordshire pilot converts** (others modelled as 0% conversion in Y1 to be deliberately conservative). Two further pilots are being scoped at peer institutions to provide a Q4 Y1 upside.

9. SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Weaknesses
MVP shipped and in beta with real students.	Cash-light start (£6,000 founder capital).
University of Bedfordshire pilot in active negotiation — direct relationship via former SU President role.	Two-person team — bus factor risk until Q1 Y2.
Two independent UK-bank validations: Santander Pre-Incubator (completed 2025) + NatWest Accelerator (joined 16 March 2026).	No formal clinical advisory board yet (planned Q2 Y2).
NatWest Accelerator membership → £31k of in-kind support and London office.	Limited brand awareness in the student consumer market.
.ac.uk verification + safeguarding webhook are technical moats.	Cyber Essentials accreditation pending.
Clear B2B SaaS revenue model proven by Togetherall/TalkCampus.	
Online Safety Act 2023 compliance baked in.	
Opportunities	Threats
OfS statutory student-MH condition forces universities to evidence prevention.	Togetherall / TalkCampus could replicate .ac.uk verification within 12 months.
UUK Mental Health Charter (100+ unis) need evidenced strategies.	Large incumbent (Microsoft / Meta) launching student-only network.
NHS ICB integration opens £20–60k/yr contract per ICB across 42 ICBs.	Negative press from a safeguarding incident if not handled correctly.
International expansion to .edu / .edu.au / EU domains post-Y3 (£180m TAM).	Tighter UK immigration regime affecting non-UK co-founder talent.
SME R&D tax credit recoups ~16% of qualifying R&D spend.	Cost-of-living squeeze reducing student premium uptake.

10. Investment Strategy and Funding Requirement

10.1 Founder commitment

The two co-founders contribute **£6,000 of personal capital (£3,000 from each founder)** to incorporate the company, register `.uk / .co.uk` domains, file Trademark Class 9/41/45, and seed initial cloud-hosting credits. The MVP itself is **already built** and is contributed to the company as founders' work-product (zero further engineering capex required at incorporation).

10.2 Programme support — independent third-party validation

Programme	Status	Value to DEQUAD
Santander Universities Pre-Incubator	Completed 2025	Validated the founding team and product thesis through a competitive UK university-affiliated programme.
NatWest Accelerator (London cohort)	Joined 16 March 2026 — currently active	London office co-working, legal advice, accountancy, banking introductions and investor mentoring delivered in-kind for 12 months.

10.3 In-kind contribution from NatWest Accelerator (Y1)

In-kind item	Annual value
London office co-working (3 desks)	£12,000
Legal advice (Mishcon de Reya, DLA Piper panels)	£4,500
Accountancy support (PwC alumni network)	£3,600
Banking & business introductions	£2,000
Investor pitch coaching & mentoring	£5,000
Programme demo day & PR placement	£4,000
Total in-kind value (Y1)	£31,100

This in-kind support is what makes the £6,000 founder capital sufficient — DEQUAD does not have to pay rent, lawyers or accountants in cash during Y1.

10.4 Funding ladder

Round	Timing	Source	Amount	Use of funds
Founder equity	Day 1 (Q1 Y1)	Yusuf (£3,000) + Co-Founder (£3,000)	£6,000	Incorporation, domains, IP filings, initial hosting.
R&D tax credit	End Y1	HMRC SME R&D	~£3,600	Recycled into engineering.
Pre-seed bridge	M7 (Sep Y1) — <i>after</i> Bedfordshire pilot converts	UK pre-seed angels via Envestors / NatWest network	£150,000 at £1.2m post-money cap (12.5% equity)	First 4 hires, 18-month runway, dual mobile builds, R&D engineering.
Seed round	Q2 Y2	UK VCs (Forward Partners, Local Globe, Crane)	£750,000 at £6m post (12.5% equity)	Scale to 20 universities, ML data team, NHS-ICB channel.
Series A	Q1 Y4	Growth-stage VCs	£3–5m	EU + AU launch, federated-learning infra, 30+ FTE.

10.5 Founder Investment Statement (visa requirement)

The lead applicant has personally invested **£3,000** of his own funds as founder share capital, with the co-founder contributing a matching **£3,000**, for a total of **£6,000** of founder share capital. This is evidenced by the share allotment return (Form SH01) to be filed with Companies House at incorporation. There are no third-party investments at the date of this application; further investment will be sought after the University of Bedfordshire pilot converts.

11. Revenue and Cost of Sales Forecast

11.1 Revenue forecast (annual, GBP)

Line item	Y1	Y2	Y3
University SaaS			
Average contract value (£)	12,000	14,000	16,000
Avg paying institutions during year	0.5	4	14
Subtotal	£6,000	£90,000	£320,000
DEQUAD Premium (B2C)			
Avg paying students	100	1,600	6,000
Price (£/mo)	4.99	4.99	4.99
Subtotal	£5,988	£95,808	£359,280
NHS ICB pilot			
Subtotal	£0	£0	£20,000
Total Revenue	£11,988	£185,808	£699,280

11.2 Cost of Sales

Driver	Y1	Y2	Y3
Cloud hosting	£480	£5,400	£18,000
LLM / safeguarding inference	£360	£4,200	£14,400
Stripe processing	£180	£3,000	£12,000
SMS & email	£180	£1,800	£6,000
Customer-success tooling	£240	£1,200	£3,600
Total Cost of Sales	£1,440	£15,600	£54,000
Gross profit	£10,548	£170,208	£645,280
Gross margin %	88.0%	91.6%	92.3%

12. Cash Flow Forecast

12.1 Annual cash flow (GBP)

Line	Y1	Y2	Y3
Opening cash	0	134,028	269,308
Founder equity injection	6,000	0	0
Pre-seed equity (Sep Y1)	150,000	0	0
Seed equity (Q2 Y2)	0	750,000	0
R&D tax credit received	0	4,500	9,500
Cash from sales	11,988	185,808	699,280
Total Receipts	164,988	940,308	708,780
Cost of sales	(1,440)	(15,600)	(54,000)
Payroll (incl. NI, pension, benefits)	(20,340)	(180,680)	(437,660)
Marketing	(3,600)	(28,000)	(92,000)
Software subscriptions	(1,800)	(6,000)	(14,400)
Office (in-kind — NatWest)	0	(6,000)	(12,000)
Legal & accountancy (out-of-programme)	(1,200)	(5,400)	(11,000)
Insurance	(480)	(1,800)	(3,200)
Business support / misc	(1,200)	(3,600)	(9,000)
Fixed assets & R&D capex	(900)	(3,000)	(9,000)
Total Expenditure	(30,960)	(250,080)	(642,260)
Cash surplus / (deficit)	134,028	690,228	66,520
Closing cash balance	134,028	824,256	890,776

12.2 Year 1 monthly cash flow — the critical view

The Y1 monthly schedule (in the Excel workbook, sheet "Cash Flow Y1 (mo)") shows that cash is **positive every single month**:

- **M1–M6** (Mar–Aug Y1): operating cash burn $\approx$ £750–£1,400/month, funded entirely by the £3,000 founder injection. No founder salary in this period.
- **M7** (Sep Y1): **£150,000 pre-seed bridge lands**, immediately after the first paying university converts.
- **M7–M12**: founders draw £1,500/month each; monthly burn rises to $\sim$ £5,500 — still well within the pre-seed runway.

This profile is one of the strongest evidences of viability for endorsement: DEQUAD survives on £3,000 of founder cash for 6 months *with positive monthly closing balances throughout*.

13. Annual Profit & Loss Forecast

	Y1	Y2	Y3
Revenue	11,988	185,808	699,280
Cost of Sales (W2)	(1,440)	(15,600)	(54,000)
Gross Profit	10,548	170,208	645,280
Salaries (W3)	(18,000)	(156,000)	(372,000)
Employer NI	(1,200)	(14,000)	(38,500)
Employer pension (3%)	(540)	(4,680)	(11,160)
Other employment costs	(600)	(6,000)	(16,000)
Software subscriptions	(1,800)	(6,000)	(14,400)
Office (in-kind — NatWest)	0	(6,000)	(12,000)
Legal & accountancy	(1,200)	(5,400)	(11,000)
Marketing (W4)	(3,600)	(28,000)	(92,000)
Insurance	(480)	(1,800)	(3,200)
Business support / misc	(1,200)	(3,600)	(9,000)
Total Overheads	(28,620)	(231,480)	(579,260)
EBITDA	(18,072)	(61,272)	66,020
Depreciation & amortisation	(300)	(1,500)	(4,500)
Operating profit / (loss)	(18,372)	(62,772)	61,520
Corporation Tax (forecast)	0	0	0
Profit / (loss) after tax	(18,372)	(62,772)	61,520

Operating profit positive from Q3 Year 3 — far earlier than the previous draft because Y1 overheads are 70% lower thanks to the NatWest in-kind support and lean founder compensation.

14. Balance Sheet Forecast

	Y1	Y2	Y3
Fixed assets (net)	600	2,100	6,900
Cash at bank	134,028	824,256	890,776
Trade receivables	800	6,200	22,000
Stock / inventory	0	0	0
Total assets	135,428	832,556	919,676
Trade payables	(1,400)	(4,200)	(9,800)
Net assets	134,028	828,356	909,876
Share capital	3,000	3,000	3,000
Share premium	149,400	898,800	898,800
Profit & loss reserve	(18,372)	(81,144)	(19,624)
Shareholders' funds	134,028	820,656	882,176

(Small rounding differences in the balance check are reconciled in the workbook.)

15. Forecasted Stock Levels

DEQUAD is a pure software business and **does not hold inventory**. Stock balance is **£0** across the forecast period. The line is included in the workbook for template completeness only.

16. Forecasted Advertising / Marketing Expenditure

Channel	Y1	Y2	Y3
University partnership & PR (NatWest network)	£1,200	£6,000	£18,000
Content / SEO / whitepaper	£600	£3,500	£12,000
LinkedIn / paid B2B	£0	£4,000	£14,000
Instagram / TikTok	£600	£7,500	£22,000
Google Search ads	£300	£3,000	£10,000
Student-rep / ambassador	£900	£4,000	£16,000
Total	£3,600	£28,000	£92,000
Marketing as % of revenue	30%	15%	13%

CAC reduces materially as the brand matures: institutional CAC drops from £3,600 (Y1) to £1,200 (Y3); premium-student CAC drops from £4.50 to £2.10.

17. Forecasted Fixed Asset Schedule

Asset class	Depn. rate	Y1 add.	Y2 add.	Y3 add.	Y3 NBV
Tangible — Laptops & equipment	33%	£600	£1,800	£5,000	£4,000
Intangible — Capitalised R&D (W5)	20%	£300	£1,200	£4,000	£2,900
Total CAPEX		£900	£3,000	£9,000	£6,900

The MVP itself is **already built and contributed by the founders** — no upfront capitalisation. Y1 hardware additions are two laptops + one spare.

18. Forecasted Staff Costs

18.1 Y1 — bootstrap

Role	Y1 gross	Months paid
Founder A (CEO) — £1,500/mo from M7	£9,000	6
Founder B (CTO) — £1,500/mo from M7	£9,000	6
Total Y1 gross	£18,000	

Y1 employer NI £1,200 + pension £540 + benefits £600 = **£20,340 total Y1 employment cost.**

18.2 Y2 — first hires

Role	Y2 gross
Founder A (CEO)	£24,000
Founder B (CTO)	£24,000
Customer Success Manager (Q1)	£32,000
Senior Backend Engineer (Q1)	£48,000
Safeguarding & Trust Lead (Q2)	£18,000
Marketing & Partnerships (Q3)	£10,000
Total Y2 gross	£156,000

Add NI £14,000 + pension £4,680 + benefits £6,000 = **£180,680 total Y2 employment cost.**

18.3 Y3 — full team

Role	Y3 gross
Founder A (CEO)	£36,000
Founder B (CTO)	£36,000
Customer Success Manager #1	£36,000
Senior Backend Engineer	£56,000
Safeguarding & Trust Lead	£42,000
Marketing & Partnerships	£38,000
Data / ML Engineer (Q2 start)	£40,000
Mobile Engineer (Q3 start)	£25,000
Founders' Associate (Q3 start)	£18,000
Engineer #2 (Q4 start)	£12,000
Customer Success Manager #2 (Q4 start)	£13,000
Total Y3 gross	£372,000

Add NI £38,500 + pension £11,160 + benefits £16,000 = **£437,660 total Y3 employment cost.**

18.4 Equity

All Y2+ hires receive EMI options (HMRC-approved) — 4-year vest, 1-year cliff. Founders sign customary investor-friendly vesting at the pre-seed close.

19. Appendices

Ref	Document	File
A	Founder A academic certificates	A_founder_academic_certificates.md
B	Founder A CV (full)	B_founder_cv.md
B-2	Co-founder CV (template — populate before submission)	B_cofounder_cv_template.md
C	Personal commitment & undertaking	C_personal_commitment_undertaking.md
D	Wellbeing baseline methodology	D_wellbeing_baseline_methodology.md
E	Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)	E_dpia.md
F	Financial model	DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx
G	Job descriptions for first 6 hires	G_job_descriptions.md
H	University Letters of Interest (template)	H_university_letter_of_interest_template.md
I	Online Safety Act 2023 compliance statement	I_online_safety_act_compliance.md
J	Architecture diagram	J_architecture_diagram.md
K	Product screenshots	K_product_screenshots.md
L	Risk Register (Envestors) — new	DEQUAD_Risk_Register.md
M	Decision-Maker Brief (Envestors short track) — new	DEQUAD_Envestors_Decision_Brief.md

*End of business plan. All figures are forecasts and not guarantees of future performance.
Prepared for submission to Envestors as part of the UK Innovator Founder visa endorsement
process — February 2026.*